

Slides 2.16: Diversification

Lesson 2.16, one day. Slides 1 to 11. Every price is from page 2 of Handout 02.14 - The Gilded Age Market Kit.md. Do not mention the boom or the crash anywhere.

Slide 1: Do now

- All \$1,000 in one company. It drops 50 percent. What is your total now?
- Now: \$1,000 split evenly across five holdings, and only one of them drops 50 percent. What is your total? Notes: 3 minutes. Answers: 500 and 900. Then the eggs.

Slide 2: Same eggs, different morning

- Twelve eggs in one basket. Drop it.
- Twelve eggs in three baskets. Drop one.
- Which investor eats breakfast? Image: two drawings: one basket on its side with cracked eggs everywhere; three baskets, one tipped, eight eggs still safe. Notes: Do it with the real (plastic) eggs first. Then the slide.

Slide 3: Diversification

- Money spread across companies with different risk levels, and the bank.
- So they do not all fall on the same news.
- 1873: the railroads fell by almost half. Oil and gas rose, because people still needed light.
- The bank never cares. Image: the price table's Round 1 column drawn large: RAIL with a down arrow, OIL and GAS with small up arrows, BANK with a flat line. Notes: Students copy the definition to the journal notes box.

Slide 4: Two pies

- Pie 1: one slice of 90 percent, a few slivers.
- Pie 2: six slices, none bigger than a quarter.
- Pie 1 wins the leaderboard in a boom and sits at the bottom in a panic.
- Pie 2 never wins big and never loses big. Image: two pie charts side by side, labeled with tickers.

Slide 5: Rebalancing

- Your pie changes shape on its own when prices move.
- Rebalancing: sell a little of what grew, buy a little of what fell, so the pie looks the way you chose.
- It is not panic and it is not chasing. It is housekeeping. Image: a pie with one slice grown too big, an arrow, and the same pie trimmed back to even.

Slide 6: Three Portfolios and a Shock

- Three investors, \$1,000 each, bought in 1882 at the Round 2 prices.
- A, the bet: all of it in ELEC and RAIL.
- B, the vault: most of it in the bank, the rest in GAS.

- C, the spread: the bank and all four companies.
- The shock: the Panic of 1893, the prices you lived through two days ago. Then Part 2: hold everything to 1901. Rank them twice.
- Pairs, calculators. 12 minutes.

Slide 7: Debrief: the Panic of 1893

- A: \$480. Lost \$520.
- B: \$988. Lost \$12.
- C: \$776. Lost \$224.
- Which one would you want in a panic? Image: three bars, 480, 988, 776, with a storm cloud above.

Slide 8: Debrief: held to 1901

- A: \$1,465. Gained \$465.
- B: \$1,097. Gained \$97.
- C: \$1,294. Gained \$294.
- Which one would you want in a recovery?
- You do not know which is coming. That is the real situation. Image: the same three bars, taller, with a sun above.

Slide 9: Round 5, 1911. My own pie.

- Sketch your pie from your Round 4 holdings on Entry 5. Label the slices.
- If one slice is bigger than half: rebalance, or hold and say why.
- Pay the bank first. Fill the column: RAIL 65, OIL 60, GAS 32, ELEC 55, STEEL 45, and two new lines, AUTO 20 and RADIO 6.
- Question from the dispatch: the government broke up the biggest monopoly in the country and its owners got richer. Why? Image: a Model T on a dirt road beside a farm, 1911. Notes: 10 minutes. Read the Round 5 dispatch after the totals are done. Four minutes of trading. Ask at the desk: what is your biggest slice? Say nothing about the next two rounds.

Slide 10: Entry 5

- What I did (use the word rebalance or hold). Why. What happened.
- My biggest slice is ___ percent, and I am comfortable / not comfortable with that because ___.
- My total at the bell, in dollars. Notes: 4 minutes.

Slide 11: Closure

- Exit card: diversification in one sentence, in your own words. Then: my biggest slice is ___ percent.
- Three investors read the sentence.
- Tomorrow: another round. Notes: 4 minutes. A sentence that only says “buy more stuff” is “needs more.” Keep a straight face about tomorrow.